

Homework 5th, Week 6th

Activity 11

ACTIVITY II



✓ 5

Write an introduction based on the following information: To what extent do you agree that new technologies and ways of buying and selling are transforming the lives of consumers?

(Introduction):

1. asking a challenging question

2. asking question

3. anecdote

The first main reason is that the development of online shopping has meant that the market for goods available to the individual has grown exponentially. It is possible to buy virtually anything from what has effectively become a worldwide retail market—exotic goods, art works, rare books, adventure holidays—the list is endless. Products that were once only available to those who lived in large cosmopolitan cities with a wide variety of shops can now be bought by those living in small towns with few local amenities.

Another significant reason is that the buyer can have more control over the process. Price comparison websites make it easier to find bargains. Shopping can be done at any time of the day or night, and shoppers can browse for as long as they like without pressure from sales assistants. This means that shoppers can potentially become more astute and knowledgeable about the products they are buying. Because of the greater competition involved in trading within a large market, sellers may have to improve the quality of their products.

In short, experience suggests that online shopping has shifted the balance of power in favor of the consumer. Consumers not only have wider access to goods but also have greater access to information and more control over how they shop.

Introduction:

Nowadays we just need to click the websites on the screen then the money goes out and the goods go in. According to the survey by Chinese Government, over 75 percentage of Chinese have used online shopping. It has deeply transform the ways of consumption, from the cash to the online. However, have you ever thought why the online shopping can make a hit throughout

the whole country? The following two reasons are my opinions that may help you understand the essence of it.

Text B

Source Text and Paragraph Analysis

Social Distance

Namrata Palta

1. We like to keep our distance from others and there are very specific social rules about how close we can go to others in particular situations. This social distance is also known as body space and comfort zone, and the use of this space is called proxemics. ***(Specify the concept of the social distance from our daily life)***
2. Regulating the distances between us and other people provides us with several benefits, including safety, communication, affection, and threat. When people are distant, they can't attack us by surprise. When people are closer, it is easier to communicate with them. When they are closer still, we can be intimate. The reverse can be used—you may deliberately threaten a person by invading their body space. ***(Emphasize the significance and benefits of regulating appropriate social distance)***
3. The social distances here are approximate, and will vary with people. But they are still a good general rule. Four zones that are common for Americans are identified: ***(Utter that different people have different social distance and introduce the four zones of social distance)***
4. **Public Zone.** The public zone is generally over 12 feet. That is, when we are walking around town, we will try to keep at least 12 feet between us and other people. For example, we will leave that space between us and the people walking in front. Of course there are many times when we cannot do this. What the theory of social distance proves is that we will start to notice other people who are within this radius. The closer they get, the more we become aware and ready ourselves for appropriate action. When we are distant from another person, we feel a degree of safety from them. A person at a distance cannot attack us suddenly. If they do seem to threaten, we will have time to **dodge**, run or prepare for battle. ***(State the social distance in public zone and explain the reasons about the safety)***
5. **Social Zone.** The social zone is generally from 4 to 12 feet. Within this zone, we start to feel a connection with other people. When they are closer, then we can talk with them without having to shout, but still keep them at a safe distance. This is a comfortable

distance for people who are standing in a group but maybe not talking directly with one another. People sitting in chairs or gathered in a room will tend to like this distance. ***(Utter the social distance in social zone and explain the reasons about the connection)***

6. **Personal Zone.** This zone is from 1.5 to 4 feet. In the personal zone, the conversation gets more direct, and this is a good distance for two people who are talking in earnest about something. ***(State the social distance in personal zone and explain the reasons about the relationship and conversation between persons)***
7. **Intimate Zone.** This zone is less than 1.5 feet. When a person is within arm's reach or closer, we can touch them in intimate ways. We can also see more detail of their body language and look them in their eyes. When they are closer, they also blot out other people so all we can see is them (and vice versa). Romance of all kinds happens in this space. ***(Show the social distance in intimate zone and explain the reasons about stimulating the intimate relationship in romantic ways)***
8. Entering somebody else's intimate zone can be very threatening. This is sometimes done as a deliberate ploy to give a non-verbal signal that they are powerful enough to invade your territory at will. ***(Emphasize the infeasibility of keep intimate social distance with somebody else)***
9. Rules about social distance vary with different groups of people. You can detect this by watching people's reactions. If you feel safe and they do not seem to feel safe, back off. If they invade your space, decide whether you should also invade their space or act otherwise. Turning sideways is an easy alternative to this, as a person to the side is less threatening than a person at the same distance in front of you. ***(People should detect and adjust the social distance with others in time)***
10. People who live in towns spend more time close to one another and so their social distances may compact somewhat. In a large and crowded city, the distances will be less than in a small town. People who normally live a long way from others will expand their social distances and may even have to lean over towards another person to shake hands and then back off to a safe distance. ***(State the different social distances between the people living in small towns and in large cities)***
^646f82
11. Different countries also have different rules about social distances. The overcrowded nature of some Asian countries means that they are accustomed to talking to others from a very close distance. Watch a Japanese person talking at a party with a person from the Western countryside. The Japanese person will step in and the Westerner will step back. Speeded up, it is like a dance around the room. ***(State the different social distances between the people from different countries)***

Significant Words and Phrases

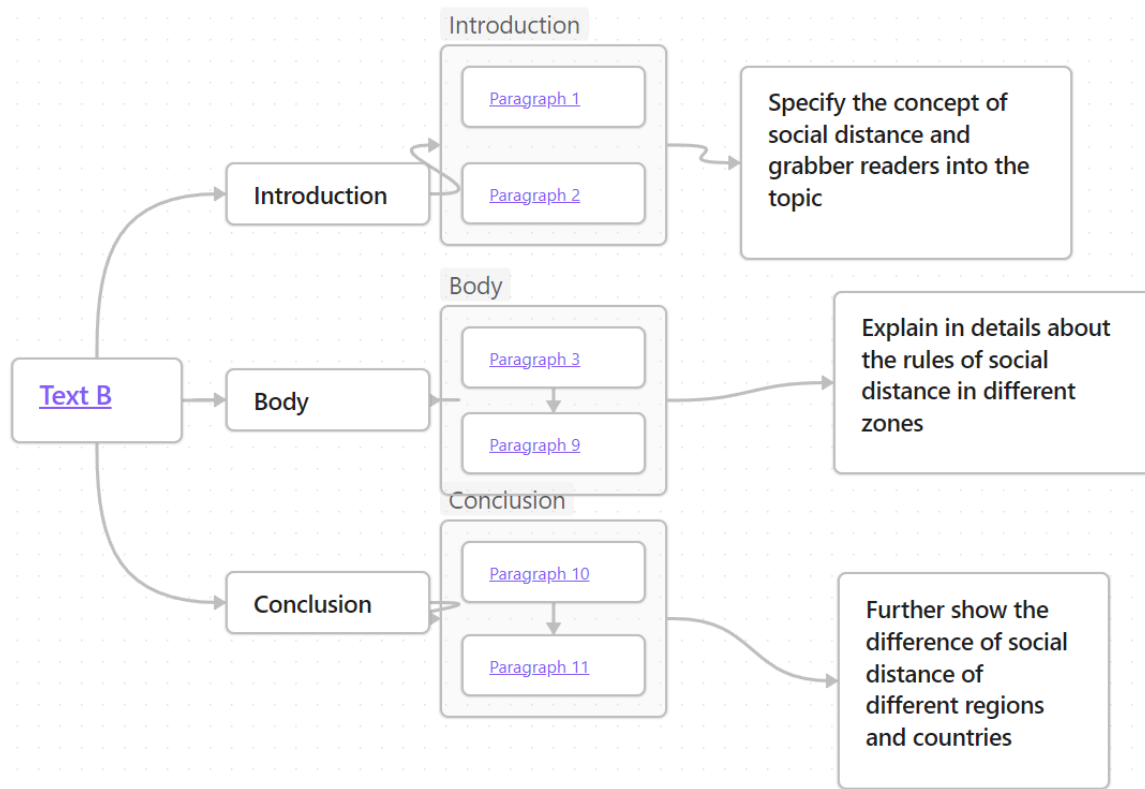
- dodge #CET6
make a sudden movement to avoid something
 - blot out #CET4 #CET6
make unclear
 - ploy
activity
 - at will #CET4 #CET6
arbitrarily
 - compact #CET4 #CET6
small
-

Topic Idea

This article introduces the concept of social distance, states the rules of social distances and the differences between different regions and countries.

Structure

Structure of text B



Activity 4

ACTIVITY 4

Task 1 Think critically about the writing techniques used in Text B and discuss the following questions in groups.

1. This essay begins with definite and assertive statements about body space in the first paragraph. How do you like this kind of introduction?
2. This essay classifies four types of social zones to measure the intimacy of relationships. Is this classification all-inclusive? Why or why not?
3. Palta uses examples to illustrate each type of social zone. Locate the examples given in the text and add examples of your own.
4. Palta claims that “Entering somebody else’s intimate zone can be very threatening.” Is this claim well supported? Why or why not? What do you think can be done to strengthen the argument?

1. I think the definite and assertive statements about the body space can make the introduction more direct and can grabber readers more swiftly. It also directly introduce the topic without useless information.
2. I think it is all inclusive because it classifies the types by the amount. The four types includes all the possible distance so it is all-inclusive.
- 3.

	Public Zone	Social Zone	Personal Zone	Intimate Zone
Author's Examples	The distance between us and the people walking in front	People sitting in chairs or gathered in a room	The conversation	The body language and the intimate deeds
My own Examples	The distance when people line up	People having dinner together	The group discussion	The whisper between the intimate persons

4. I think it is not well supported since it just have a claim but no sufficient examples, which make the claim not convincing. To strengthen the argument, we can deeply explain the concept and give more examples.

Task 2 Read the following paragraph about proxemics. Conduct a mini observation study of the social distance and spatial patterns among your classmates. Pay attention to the proxemic differences that characterize male-to-male, male-to-female, and female-to-female communication respectively. Write a paragraph reporting your findings.

In communication studies the description and analysis of the spatial-physical relationships among communicators is called proxemics. Proxemics generally refers to the actual distance between speakers as well as spatial patterns such as angle and direction. For example, the sociolinguist Deborah Tannen has noted that Euro-American men do not typically face one another directly when they are talking. Instead, American men tend to face outward, away from one another and only occasionally glance at each other. According to Tannen they are careful to avoid excessive direct eye contact. The anthropologist and linguist Edward Hall has noted that people from various Arab countries, especially the men, tolerate a much closer distance when talking than do Euro-American men. Moreover, Arab men often look directly at one another when they are conversing. Hall has noted that proxemics provides insight into the subtle cultural rules that regulate communicative interaction. Hall has also noted that when people of differing cultural backgrounds come together and attempt to communicate, the cultural rules for spatial patterning can often cause a significant degree of confusion and frustration for the participants.

In my observation of classmates' interactions, distinct proxemic differences are as following. For male-to-male communication, my classmates often stood at a moderate distance and they rarely faced each other directly. Instead, they would angle their bodies, perhaps facing slightly to the side. Eye contact was uncommon, with long periods of looking away. They might be more comfortable focusing on a point in the environment rather than directly at one another. In male-to-female interactions, the distance seemed to be more distant. Males would maintain more distance, showing respect and males were more likely to face females directly, with more frequent but still not too much eye contact. Females, on the other hand, generally kept a composed posture, with a distance that suggested a balance between comfort and engagement. Regarding female-to-female communication, classmates often stood closer, sometimes almost shoulder-by-shoulder. They faced each other more directly and maintained relatively longer eye contact. Their body language indicated a greater level of comfort in their interaction.



2024 年 12 月大学英语四级考试真题（第 1 套）

Part I

Writing

(30 minutes)

Directions: Suppose the business school of your university is conducting a survey to collect students' opinions on the express delivery service industry in China. You are to write a response about its recent development and its impact on people's lives. You will have 30 minutes to write the essay. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

Part II

Listening Comprehension

(25 minutes)

Section A

Directions: In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once. After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked A), B), C) and D). Then mark the corresponding letter on *Answer Sheet 1* with a single line through the centre.

Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard.

1. A) She is making a special effort to be recognized.
B) She has been living in Fayetteville for 25 years.
C) She has been driving a school bus ever since 2009.
D) She is the longest-serving bus driver in Fayetteville.
2. A) The importance of their service to the city.
B) The number of riders they serve in the city.
C) The new proclamation issued early this week.
D) The significance of the event to take place March 18.

Questions 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

3. A) Budgeted \$56.7 million for the coming school year.
B) Requested to raise teachers' salaries by 3 percent.
C) Proposed a spending increase by 5.99 percent.
D) Kept raising funds for at least 8 budget cycles.
4. A) Decrease in salaries for school administrators.
B) Reduction in federal and state funding.
C) Firing of less qualified faculty members.
D) Closing down of some less competitive schools.

Questions 5 to 7 are based on the news report you have just heard.

5. A) They often take place in the Scottish highlands.
B) They usually happen in the middle of the night.

With the swift development of the productivity, the express delivery service has made a hit recently due to its convenience. Students in our business school have a plenty of valuable opinions as well and so I am. Hence I am honor to share my actual experience and points of view about the express delivery about both its recent development and its impact on our live. As far as I am concerned, the recent development about the service has received affluent results not only in accelerating speed but also in improving service quality. Thanks to the progress of the transposition system, the express delivery can be transported in time by plane or other rapid approaches rather than just use the tracks as the past, which apparently promotes the speed of delivery. We can also easily obtain our goods before our deadline. Meanwhile, the new technique of transposition also decrease the possibility of breaking down the goods or losing them on the road, which enhance the equality of delivery. Hence, we can experience the transformation of the express delivery recently in person. I am so grateful about the contribution of our government and the excellent workers, which provide an extremely satisfied service for us.

Part II

1. Driver ^{celebrate} Saturday
^{keen} 25 children.
^{the day} 2007 ^{longest} sewing
C. D

2. A

3. 5.88 fee
2.11 2015-2014

Budget school.
enrollment.
A. C

4. B

5. Bomb snow
plan. crash
building. calm.

thunder
careful.
trains.
D

6. A 7. B

8. city centre. 3 months
replace. afford.
wasteful. embarrassment.
not good. phone.

pay. credit card
bad habit.
B.

9. C 10. D 11. B

12. moving share. think home.
movement. increasing.

houses. 70 to
happy. 100.
change. afford. why.

so benefit advocate
good option less land. B P

13. A.

14. A

15. B⁰

16. kids
confidence.
well-being
overcome. healthy

2. movement. as

writing.

2. stress. focus

concern

any or.

6 mental
healthy

starts early

early to
life-long love
optional balls

B.

17. C. 18. A

19. ^{diverting} job. ^{over} salary
attractive. ^{two groups}
online.

a gender.

the diversity

D. C

baseline.

20. C A 21 D.

22. ^{match. behavior} helps children family
helps social

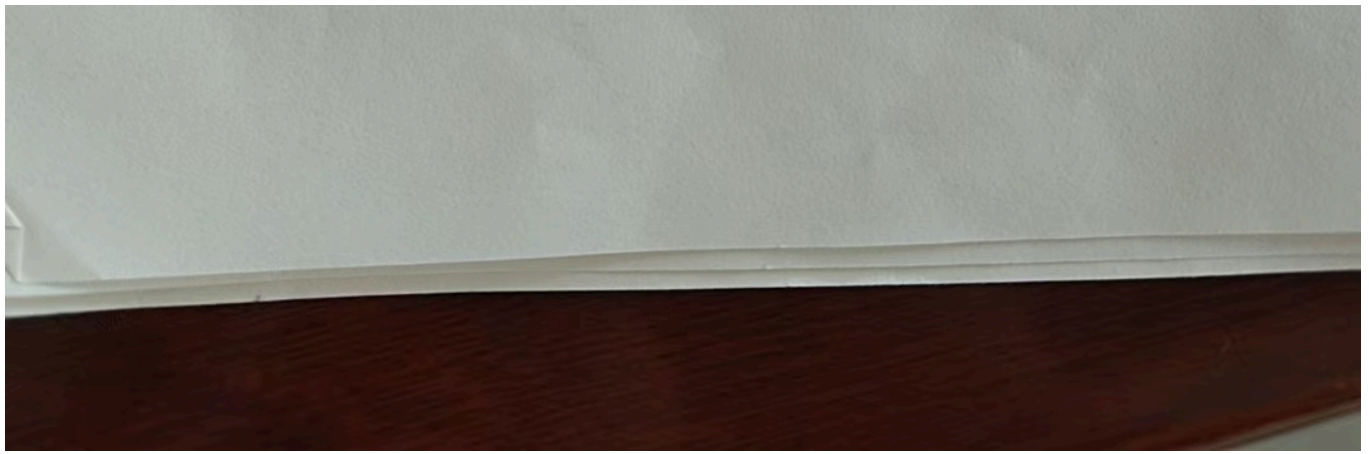
manage. structure.

gender ^{with children} ~~disrupt~~

less than adult
training A C

23. A. 24. C A 25. B.

15/25.



Part III

Section A

- 26. N
- 27. ~~G~~ I
- 28. ~~M~~ F
- 29. E
- 30. H
- 31. A
- 32. ~~O~~ L
- 33. B
- 34. J
- 35. C

Section B

- 36. B
- 37. J
- 38. E
- 39. ~~I~~ L
- 40. ~~H~~ G
- 41. D
- 42. K
- 43. A
- 44. ~~G~~ H
- 45. C

Section C

Passage One

- 46. C
- 47. A
- 48. ~~D~~ B
- 49. C
- 50. D

Passage Two

- 51. A B
- 52. D
- 53. B
- 54. D
- 55. A

Part IV

Chinese Government extremely concentrate on the protection of the environment. In the recently past years, China has made obvious achievements in reducing the pollution of air, water and soil. China also take a set of valid measures, including developing the clear power, improving public transposition system, spreading shared bicycle and taking the classification of trash. Through these measures, the cities and villages are becoming greener and more beautiful. China has involved in the international cooperation as well, which contributes to the global environmental protection a lot.